

WHOOOP

Art direction and visual identity system

The quiet after the effort, shown back to you.



Decide the look before generating a single frame

THE IDEA, ONE LINE

WHOOOP looks like the quiet after the effort, not the effort itself. The recovery coach shows the work in stillness, in soft light, with one number that matters.

REFERENCE

Golf 'Monthly Averages' post (data sits quietly over a real athlete). B&W 'You Saw The Win' poster (grit, grain, one line of type). Gold-band editorial (restraint, membership not gadget).

SUBJECT & COMPOSITION

Real people around effort and in ordinary life, candid, never posed. Shot tight and off-center, film-still crops, deliberate empty space. The band is on the wrist, never the subject.

LIGHT & COLOR

Soft, diffused light: overcast, window, dawn or dusk. Muted, graded-down palette, lifted blacks, cool shadows. Saturated color only as data or one teal highlight.

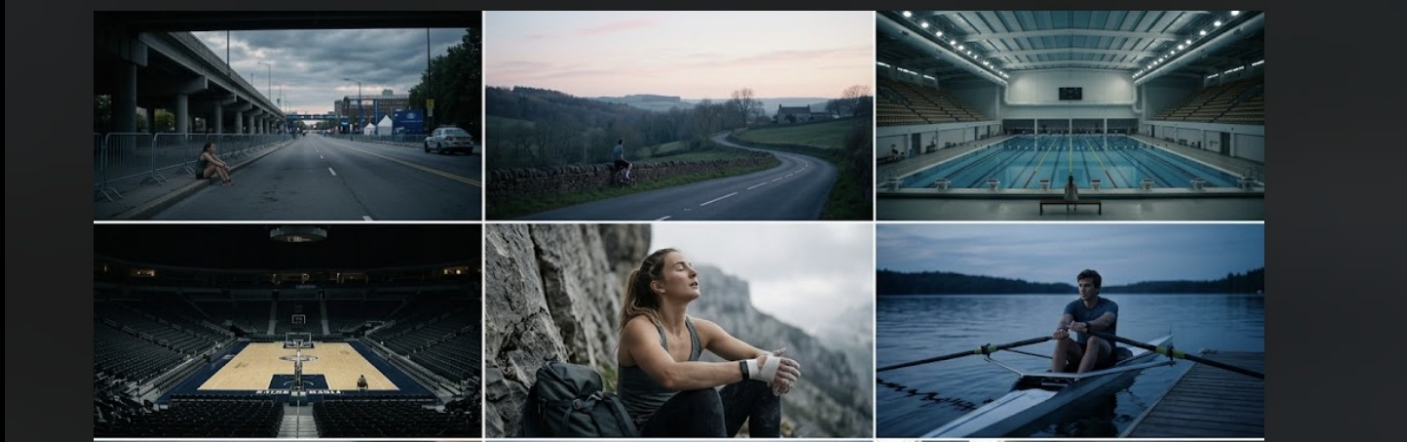
MEDIUM & ERA

Photoreal, cinema glass, fine film grain. A 2020s prestige-documentary feel, not a 2015 fitness ad.

THE ANTI-BRIEF

Never a photo shoot or posed smile. Never hard flash or mid-scream exertion. Never a product hero shot with feature callouts. Never neon-on-black or blue-to-purple gradients. Never more than one saturated color per frame.

The argument: candid, alone, soft light



Frames 1–6

1 Underpass, rest on the curb

The quiet around effort: candid rest in an ordinary place, not sport.

2 Cyclist, dawn road

Muted palette: desaturated but for a soft dawn sky.

3 Empty pool, lone figure

Negative space: one off-center subject in a vast built space.

4 Empty arena

Stillness after the event, not the peak.

5 Climber resting, chalk

Grit: real texture and effort in a body at rest.

6 Rower, dusk lake

Cool blue-hour grade; the band on the wrist in context.

Scale, soft light, and the black-and-white treatment



7 Tennis courts, from above

Scale: the subject tiny in a wide frame, silence as composition.

8 Weight room, window light

Soft light: large diffuse daylight, gentle falloff, no flash.



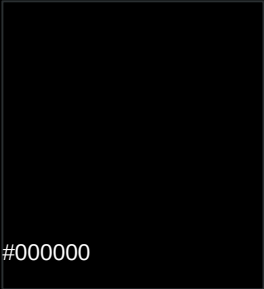
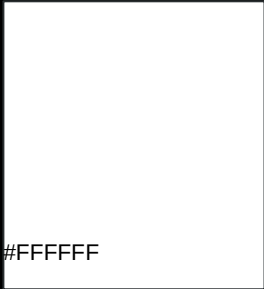
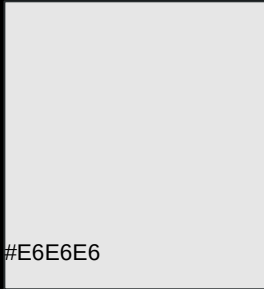
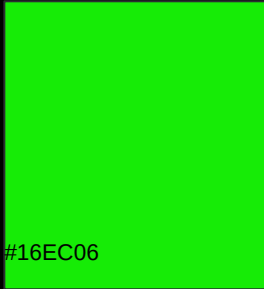
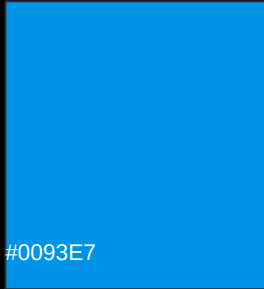
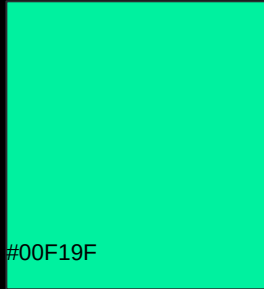
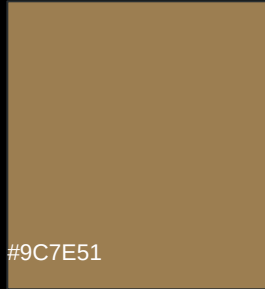
9 Golfer, follow-through (B&W)

The high-contrast black-and-white treatment; the band worn mid-play, never shot as a product.

An unannotated board is a collage. Each frame here carries one instruction the system obeys.

Color and type

COLOR · BLACK DOMINATES 60–70%, ONE ACCENT PER LAYOUT

							
#000000	#0E1213	#FFFFFF	#E6E6E6	#16EC06	#0093E7	#00F19F	#9C7E51
Black Ground. 60–70% of any layout.	Carbon Data panels.	White Type and marks.	Fog Light poster ground.	Recovery Data only.	Strain Data only.	Teal One accent, once per layout.	Gold Premium material.

TYPE · PROXIMA NOVA (MONTSERRAT FALLBACK), ONE NUMERIC FACE

Display 56/56 regular

Body 16/24 regular · Label 14 BOLD CAPS +tracking · Metric 48 bold

67
RECOVERY

Spacing, layout, and imagery direction

SPACING & LAYOUT

- Scale: 4 / 8 / 16 / 24 / 32 / 48 / 64 px.
- Margins: 48px minimum on any surface.
- Blocks: 32px between; sections 64px apart.
- One idea per view. No more than two type sizes on a surface.
- Images run full-bleed; type stays small and anchored to a corner.
- Data panels stack metrics, centered, split by 1px hairline rules.

IMAGERY DIRECTION

- Candid, never a photo shoot. No posing, no styling, no looking at the lens.
- Not only sport: athletes around effort sit beside people wearing WHOOP through ordinary life, at rest, in leisure.
- Soft, diffused light. Muted, desaturated grade, lifted blacks, cool shadows.
- Two treatments: muted color behind a data panel, or high-contrast B&W with the strap as the only jewellery.
- Fine film grain on every photo. Darken under type with a black scrim, not a panel.

Components and anti-rules

COMPONENTS · THE REPEATING PATTERNS

Data panel

67% · 49 BPM · 13.6, stacked and split by hairlines

Stat callout

one metric-xl numeral, caps label under

Section header

eyebrow caps + one sentence-case line

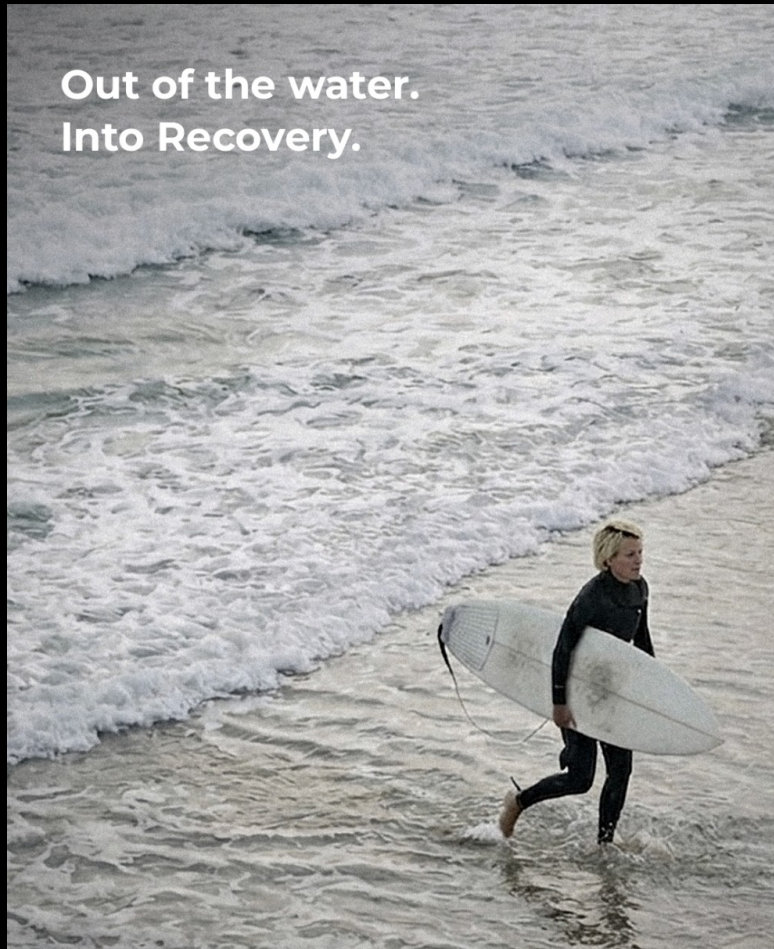
Quote block

one line, no quotation marks, muted attribution

ANTI-RULES · WHAT THIS BRAND NEVER DOES

- Never looks staged or posed, or smiles at the camera.
- Never a fitness tracker for competition only. Leisure and rest are on-brand; gym-bro hype is not.
- Never a product hero shot with floating feature callouts.
- Never hard flash or high saturation. Light is soft; the only bright color is data or one teal.
- Never the tech cliché: neon-on-black, blue-to-purple gradients, busy or maximal layouts.
- Never the no-word list in copy, a named competitor, or the legacy red.

Out of the water. Into Recovery.



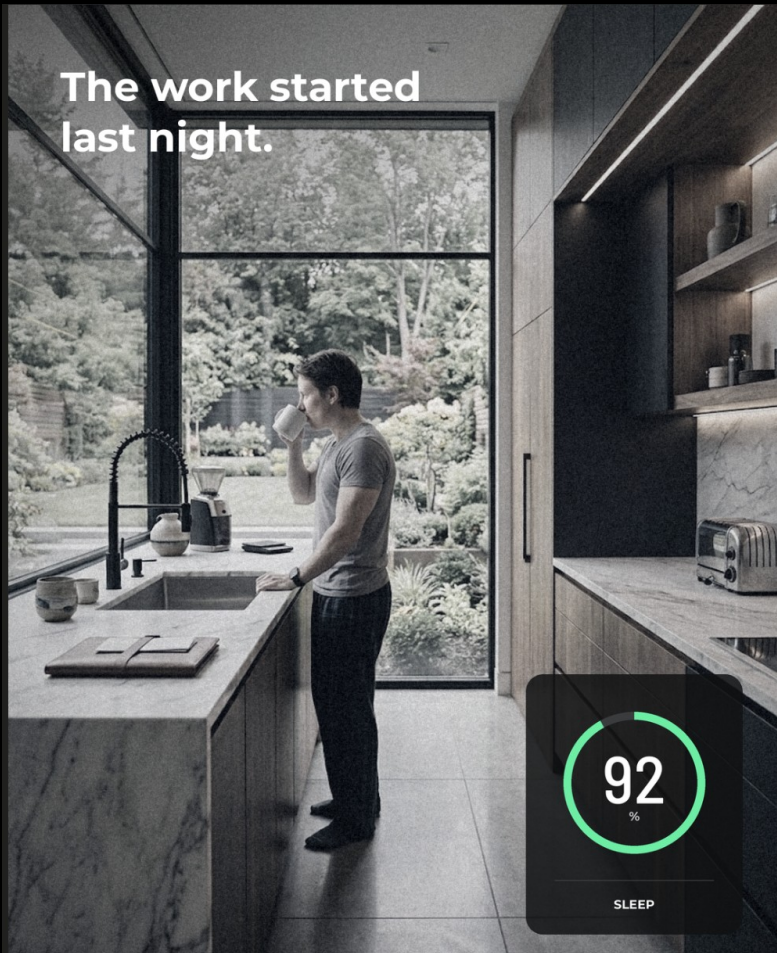
THE PROMPT, IN FULL

Candid documentary photograph, shot from above, of a lone surfer in a black wetsuit walking out of shallow surf carrying a white board, not looking at the camera; a thin black fitness band on the wrist; soft overcast dusk light, no flash; muted desaturated grade, cool grey-green water, lifted blacks; wide film-still crop with the foam line running across empty water; cinema glass, fine 35mm grain; prestige documentary, 2020s. Headline set top-left in white sans.

ART-DIRECTION RATIONALE

Competition-adjacent but caught after the session, not on the wave, so the brand reads as the coach that meets you when the effort ends. The high angle and the empty foam line give the silence the system asks for; the band is on the wrist, never the subject.

The work started last night.



THE PROMPT, IN FULL

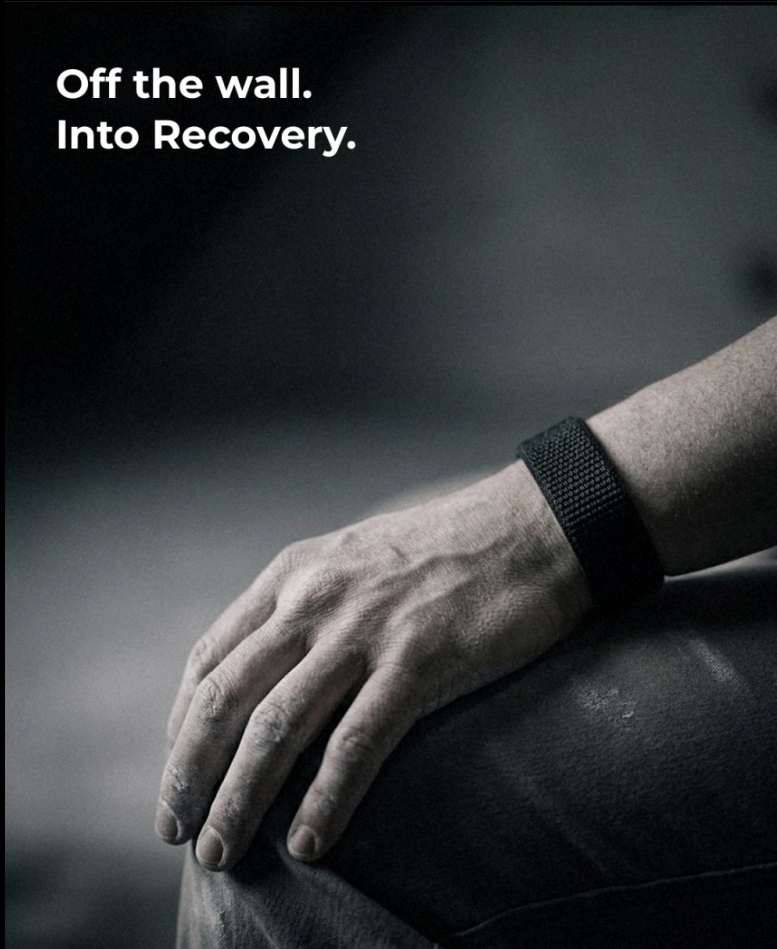
Candid photograph of a man in a t-shirt at a floor-to-ceiling kitchen window in early morning, drinking coffee, in profile, not looking at the camera; a thin fitness band on the wrist; soft green garden light through the glass, deep interior shadows; muted desaturated palette, marble and dark wood; wide shot, off-center, deliberate empty space; a WHOOP Sleep data panel reading 92% lower-right; cinema glass, fine grain; quiet 2020s documentary.

ART-DIRECTION RATIONALE

Leisure and morning, not a workout, to prove the membership lives in ordinary life. The Sleep dial is the only saturated color and it carries the argument, that recovery is the story before the day starts. Unposed and window-lit, it obeys the candid rule while showing the data moat.

Off the wall. Into Recovery.

**Off the wall.
Into Recovery.**



THE PROMPT, IN FULL

Extreme close-up, candid, of a climber's chalked hand at rest on a dusty knee after a session, the textured mesh of a thin black fitness band on the wrist; low-key soft light, deep shadows, one gentle highlight on the veins and chalk; near-monochrome muted grade, faint cool tone; macro depth of field, most of the frame in shadow; fine film grain, cinema glass; understated, abstract. Headline top-left in white sans.

ART-DIRECTION RATIONALE

Texture over face: chalk, skin and strap mesh say the effort without a person performing it. The near-black frame is the understated end of the system, the visual that barely speaks and trusts the viewer to lean in.

Auditing the output against the system

WHERE IT FLATTENED

The kitchen visual (02) leans toward a luxury real-estate ad: the architecture could carry any premium brand. What pulls it back is the Sleep dial and the band. Without that one data panel, it flattens to the category average.

WHERE IT DRIFTED

Consistency between assets. Two headline lock-ups appeared ('Into Recovery.' on 01 and 03, a standalone line on 02), and the data panel shows on only one of the three. The rule that broke: one campaign system, applied the same way across a set.

WHAT I CHANGED

Added two rules: campaign headlines use the locked 'Out of the [context]. Into Recovery.' format, and a set carries the data panel once, bottom-right, single accent. Rejected adding a dial to all three, which would have overused the data color.

The test: name removed, would these three read as one company? The muted grade, soft light and single data accent say yes; the headline system is what needed the fix.